

THE BEST PC MONEY CAN BUY

Budget? What budget?

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This has been one of the best years for the personal computer by far. We've seen insanely powerful computing products being released, new technologies surface that simply obliterate what you'd have bought just last year and there's still more to come in the next two months. Building a PC right now doesn't make too much sense, but then sensible is boring! If we had an unlimited budget, this is what we'd buy:

CPU - INTEL CORE i9-7980XE

This 18-core monster is part of the new Core i9 lineup from Intel. It's ridiculously expensive compared to AMD's Threadripper 1950X which offers two fewer cores, but Intel has a legacy that ensures optimization which AMD cannot boast of at the moment. You could easily do away with the 7980XE and opt for a Intel Core i9-7960X and you wouldn't be far behind. No matter what application, however, the 7980XE is always ahead of the 7960X.

CPU COOLER - NZXT KRAKEN X61

Cooling the most powerful HEDT CPU

on the planet is no menial task, it's one that needs liquid cooling and the Kraken NZXT is by far one of the best for the purpose. It's compatible with virtually every platform that came out over the last decade and provides ample headroom for overclocking.

MOTHERBOARD - GIGABYTE AORUS X299 GAMING 9 / MSI X299 XPOWER GAMING AC

Picking the right motherboard is absolutely essential in ensuring the best possible set of features. The GIGABYTE AORUS X299 GAMING 9 is one such board with every imaginable feature under the sun included. Except for one, the ability to run a 4-way multi-GPU configuration. Which is why we've provided the MSI X299 XPOWER GAMING AC as the alternative. It's one of the few boards to have been tested with 4-way NVIDIA GTX TITAN Xp successfully. Yeah, we know SLI on the Pascal family of graphics cards has been at the centre of controversy since its launch but we've seen folks with 4x Pascal cards running video games such as GTA V with ease.

However, we are not going to be using 4-way SLI. It's well known that

with PCIe lanes being shared between different interfaces, using a 4-way SLI configuration will render some of the other interfaces that we want to use, sub-optimal. And two-way SLI on the NVIDIA TITAN Xp is more than sufficient for every AAA title out there now. So what are we going to be using the other PCIe ports for? Super fast RAID!

ACCESSORIES - ASUS HYPER M.2 X16

One of the new features to make its way onto the consumer product line is VROC (Virtual RAID on CPU). The implementation of the same has ruffled a few feathers in the enthusiast community because Intel requires that you purchase a separate VROC dongle to enable this feature and you could only use it with Intel SSDs. However, all that was before the feature was properly implemented. We've recently seen more information make its way out and as it stands now, you can use RAID 0 on VROC without the dongle, and select third-party SSDs are also supported.

This is where the ASUS HYPER M.2 x16 CARD comes into the picture. Usually motherboards will have different